

Fact Sheet

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Male, Wilpena, Flinders Ranges, S.A. [2001-152a]



Aedeagus, dorsal view (Wilpena, South Australia, 2001-152a)



Aedeagus, lateral view (Wilpena, South Australia, 2001-152a)



Distribution

Ta95

Name

Trachymela sp. Ta95

Reference specimen

2001-152b, Wilpena, South Australia.

Adult Description

Length: ♀ 4.7-5.5 mm (2), ♂ 4.6-4.9 mm (3).

Colour: **head:** uniformly light brown, at most with same small, vaguely darker flecks around base of eyes and antennal insertions, **labrum** straw-brown; dark-brown or black-tipped mandibles; antennae uniformly straw-brown; **pronotum:** brown, same shade as head, with two prominent broad quadrate black patches situated one on each side between eyes and **humeral callus** and extending from anterior to posterior edge, sometimes these patches are not black but of a darker brown than rest of surface

and/or reduced in size; **scutellum:** brown, same shade as pronotum, usually narrowly edged in darker brown; **elytra:** brown, same shade as pronotum, with a broad dark-brown or (less commonly) black band extending from anterior elytral margin just above **humeral callus** to around elytral summit, another is situated just inside margin of elytral disc and extends from about its midpoint to apex, less often, the elytral suture from just past summit to apex is broadly bordered in dark-brown or black; punctures are similar to or a slightly darker shade than interstices, humeral callus usually darker than surrounding area; **venter:** light- to mid-brown with metaventrites sometimes slightly darker in shade, at least laterally, inside surface of elytral **epipleura** brown. **Waxy dorsal covering:** mostly of a uniform light brown colour, distributed relatively evenly though elevated areas such as **verrucae** and ridges tend to be dust-free, with the thin, central transverse ridge appearing as a fine line across the dust layer.

Head; punctures moderately large (pd~1.5-2xef) and slightly unevenly and densely packed. Antennae short, particularly in females (AL ♂=39-43%BL, ♀=31-32%BL), filiform. **Pronotum;** almost evenly curved transversely, **foveal depression** absent with epidermis usually slightly elevated in a small pustule behind eyes, discal area with surface noticeably uneven, usually with a shallow depression in centre, punctures relatively large, usually slightly larger than those on head, clearly to more vaguely impressed, evenly to slightly unevenly distributed and relatively dense (spacing~2-3pd), becoming much more coarse at lateral margins. Front margins join lateral margins in a smoothly rounded right-angle, with lateral margin initially straight, often for more than half of distance to rear margin, before curving smoothly and gradually towards rear margin, broadest just in front of postero-lateral angle. **Scutellum;** punctured, with punctures similar in size and density to those on pronotum, less often, unpunctured. **Elytra;** surface evenly to slightly unevenly curved, punctures distinct and relatively large, closely spaced and quite evenly distributed on disc and marginal area over anterior two-third of surface, becoming more closely spaced and smaller in posterior third, with a few very fine punctures scattered on the interstices, a thin, rarely partially interrupted

elevated ridge runs transversely from elytral summit to middle of edge of elytron with surface not noticeably depressed anterior to it, many laterally-oriented, wrinkle-like ridges are scattered both in front of and behind the central ridge, with a few small round, elevated **verrucae** scattered about the surface primarily posterior to the central ridge, surface continuous under humeral callus. Vertical extension of **epipleura** considerable ($H_{CE}/PW=0.40-0.43$). **Venter**; **Prosternal process** almost parallel, open or very lightly closed anteriorly, a sparse scatter of setae present along **prosternal process** and on mesosternum, a single long seta present on median and posterior trochanters, 1 or 2 on anterior trochanters; front edge of metasternum beveled, slightly rounded. **Aedeagus**; short ($L_{PE}=27-30\%BL$), linear, in dorsal view, approximately parallel-sided from basal sulcus to middle, then widening very slightly and evenly towards apex with widest point ($W_{PE} = 0.3 \cdot L_{PE}$) very close to apex, sides then turn inwards sharply so that anterior is almost perpendicular to long axis, tip triangular and small, sides of the relatively large **ostium** converge slightly so that it is almost quadrate, with anterior slightly wider than posterior extreme, dorso-median channel does not extend past **ostium** and dorsal flaps extend to a little behind **spatula**; in lateral view, very lightly curved throughout, with a very slight downward bend interrupting it about 15% of distance from apex and also thinning from this point to apex, tip continues on same plane, neither deflexed nor reflexed.

Larvae

unknown.

Eggs

unknown.

Similar species

Ta114 – this species is of similarly small size as **Ta95** and they can be difficult to separate. **Ta114** does not have the dark-brown band along the inside of the margin of the elytral disc that is present, at least as a darkening, on most specimens of **Ta95**. Its central transverse ridge is less clearly defined than that of **Ta95** and does not extend all the way to the elytral margin. **Ta114** usually has the centre of the disc of the pronotum slightly elevated rather than depressed, as is the case in **Ta95**. The **aedeagus** of the two species is of a quite different form.

Ta10 –largely overlaps in both size and distribution with **Ta95**, and lightly marked specimens of **Ta10** are almost impossible to differentiate from it. It usually has black markings on the head, and the black markings on the **elytra** are generally more extensive, though in the same position of those of **Ta95**. The verrucae are slightly different in nature to those of **Ta95**, being less expanded longitudinally and the central transverse ridge does not quite reach the elytral margin. In addition, **Ta95** never has any black colour ventrally.

Notes

This very small species has so far been found only in the Flinders Ranges of South Australia, where it is recorded from a species of box eucalypts, almost certainly *Eucalyptus intertexta* (Symphyomyrtus : Adnataria).